

# Agricultural Policy and Economics

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## Science

May, 2026

# Agricultural Policy and Economics (A07581)

**Short Title:** Agri. Policy and Economics  
**Faculty** Science and Computing  
**Department** Science  
**Cluster** Business  
**Author** JGERAGHTY  
**Credits** 5

**Level:** Advanced

## Description of Module / Aims

The purpose of this module is to study and evaluate the wider economic and policy environment which influences the agricultural industry. A wide range of topics are studied which directly or indirectly have a bearing on policy development, the economic prospects of the sector, and influence the contribution of agriculture to wider social and environmental objectives.

## Programmes

AGRI-0104 BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Agriculture) (WD\_SBSAG\_B)

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## Indicative Content

- History of Irish agricultural trade and agriculture's current contribution to the national economy
- Principles of agricultural policy: Principles of microeconomics; Rationale for support for agriculture; Alternative support measures; Agriculture as provider of public goods; Economic, social and environmental implications
- European Union and the Common Agricultural Policy: Enlargement; Objectives and Reform of the CAP; EU Budget and Ireland's contribution; non-market CAP policies and policies impacting on agriculture
- Comparative agricultural support systems: EU (CAP) v USA v Asia/Pacific v South America
- Principles of macroeconomics and international economic developments
- International trade in agricultural products: Current and emerging trade patterns; WTO rules and commitments; Trade conflicts
- Long term trends analysis: Population; incomes; lifestyle/market preferences; environmental protection; energy conservation; global warming
- Agricultural data sourcing and analysis: Compendium of Agricultural Statistics (Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine); National Farm Survey - current and recent trends (Teagasc); Annual Review and Outlook in Agriculture, Food and the Marine (DAFM); Aggregate output, input and incomes - current and recent years (CSO); International data (OECD)

## Learning Outcomes

*On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:*

1. Evaluate the contribution of agriculture to national economic, social and environmental objectives.
2. Appraise current developments in the national and international economic environment.
3. Assess key features of agriculture support policy regimes.
4. Assess the implications for agriculture of likely trends emanating from the sector itself or from outside the sector.
5. Collect and analyse data relevant to general performance and the agricultural sector in particular.

## Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Case studies.
- Visiting speakers and attendance at conferences or outside developments (where applicable).
- Video and webcast presentations.

## Assessment Methods

|                            | Weighing | Outcomes Assessed |
|----------------------------|----------|-------------------|
| Final Written Examination  | 70%      | 1,2,3             |
| Continuous Assessment      | 30%      |                   |
| <i>In-Class Assessment</i> | 15%      | 5                 |
| <i>Assignment</i>          | 15%      | 4                 |

## Assessment Criteria

**<40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

**40%-49%:** Demonstrate a good knowledge of the key learning outcomes including the contribution that agriculture makes to the Irish economy. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in both assignment and exam.

**50%-59%:** Demonstrate a good understanding of agriculture in the wider EU and world context. The student will be able to source relevant data and present it in a clear manner in both assignment and exam.

**60%-69%:** Demonstrate a detailed knowledge of all the topics including the impact of European and world trade on Irish agriculture. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a clear manner in both assignment and exam.

**70%-100%:** Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, including the current and future trends in Irish, EU and competitor trading blocks. The student will be able to source key data and present it in a convincing manner in both assignment and exam.

### Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

## Learning Modes

| Learning Mode        | F/T Hours | P/T Hours |
|----------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Lecture              | 36        |           |
| Independent Learning | 99        |           |

## Essential Material

- Colman, D. *The Economics of the European Union*. 3rd ed. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2001.
- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. *Annual Review & Outlook in Agriculture, Food and the Marine*. Dublin. Annual.

- Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine. \_Compendium of Irish Agricultural Statistics\_ Dublin. 2013.
- Hennessy, T. and B. Moran. \_National Farm Survey\_. Dublin: Teagasc, Annual Publication.
- O'Hagan, J. and C. Newman. \_The Economy of Ireland\_. 12th ed. Dublin: Gill & Macmillan, 2014.

## **Supplementary Material**

- "Agricultural Output Data." [www.oecd.org](http://www.oecd.org). 31/08/2015. <https://data.oecd.org/agriculture.htm>
- McAleese, D. \_Economics for Business\_. 3rd ed. England: Prentice Hall Financial Times, 2004.